Skilled Independent visa (subclass 189)

# Points-tested stream

This visa lets invited workers with skills we need, to live and work permanently anywhere in Australia.

## Overview

### Stay

Permanently

### Cost

From AUD6,135.00 (concessions apply in limited circumstances)

#### Cost Concession

From 1 July 2026, a lower visa cost applies to eligible Pacific Island and Timor-Leste citizens who lodge a valid visa application. See About this visa *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-listing/skilled-independent-189/points-tested#About)*.

To work out what your visa will cost, use the Visa Pricing Estimator *(/visas/visa-pricing-estimator)*. The estimator does not take into account any other costs.

### Processing times

For an indication of processing times for this visa, use the visa processing time guide tool *(/visas/getting-a-visa/visa-processing-times/global-visa-processing-times)*. This will show the processing times for recently decided applications. It is a guide only and not specific to your application.

### With this visa, you can

- work and study anywhere in Australia
- sponsor eligible relatives for permanent residence
- if eligible, become an Australian citizen *(/citizenship/become-a-citizen)*

See all conditions *(/visas/already-have-a-visa/check-visa-details-and-conditions/see-your-visa-conditions?product=189-63)*

Check your eligibility *(#Eligibility)*

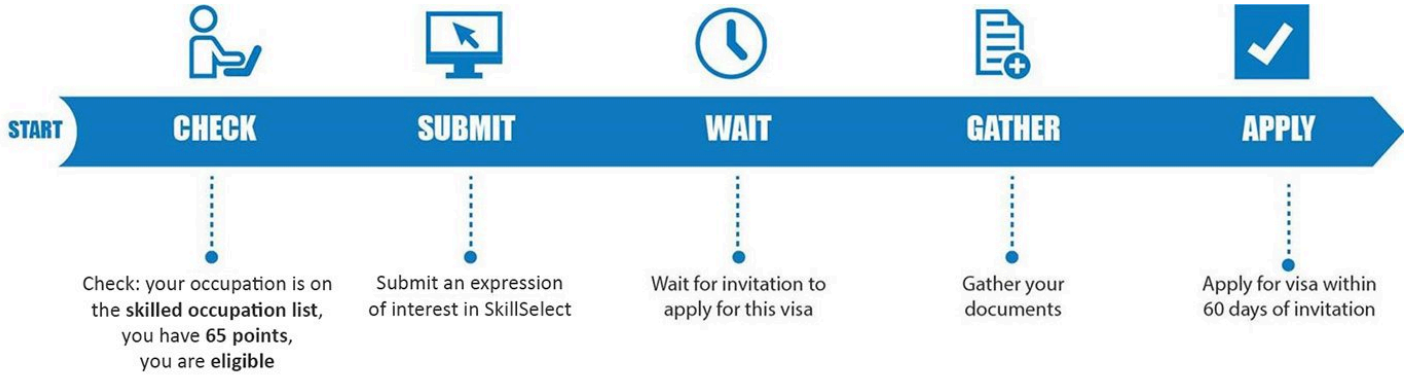
### You must

- have an occupation on the relevant skilled occupation list *(/visas/working-in-australia/skill-occupation-list)*
- have a suitable skills assessment *(/visas/working-in-australia/skills-assessment)* for the occupation
- be invited to apply for this visa
- satisfy the points test

### Help with your visa

If you are getting help with your visa, before you pay someone, read information on Who can help with your visa application *(/help-support/who-can-help-with-your-application/overview)*.

## Process




Last updated:
1 July 2026